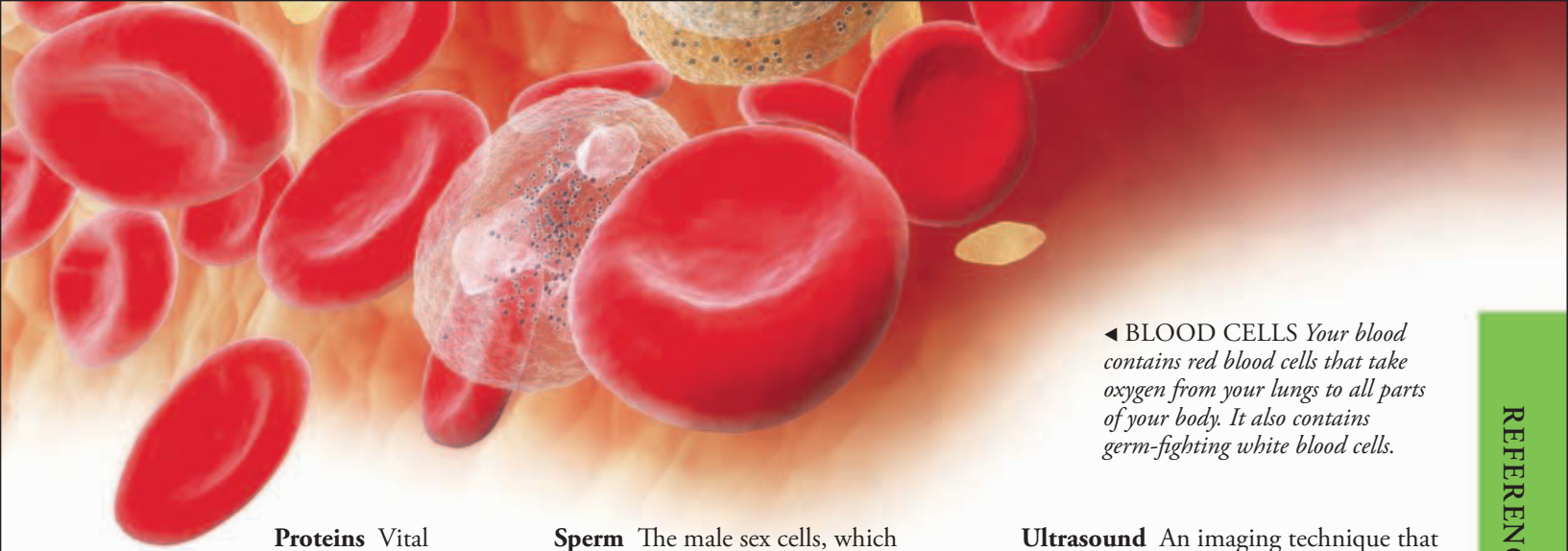




◀ **BLOOD CELLS** *Your blood contains red blood cells that take oxygen from your lungs to all parts of your body. It also contains germ-fighting white blood cells.*

Proteins Vital nutrients that help your body build new cells. Food such as meat, eggs, fish, and cheese are rich in proteins.

Red blood cell A disk-shaped cell that contains hemoglobin (a protein that carries oxygen and makes your blood red).

Reflex A rapid, automatic reaction that is out of your control, such as blinking when something moves toward your eyes.

Retina A layer of light-sensitive neurons lining the back of each eye. The retina captures images and relays them to the brain as electrical signals.

Saliva The liquid in your mouth. Saliva helps you taste, swallow, and digest food.

Scanning Any technique used to create images of soft tissues and organs inside the human body.

Sebum An oily liquid that keeps your hair and skin soft, flexible, and waterproof.

Sensory neuron A type of nerve cell (neuron) that carries impulses from your sense organs to the central nervous system.

Sensory receptor A specialized nerve cell or the end of a sensory neuron that detects a stimulus, such as light, scent, touch, or sound.

Sex chromosome One of two chromosomes present in each body cell that determine whether you are male or female.

Sperm The male sex cells, which are made in, and released from, a man's testes.

Sphincter A ring of muscle around a passageway or opening that opens and closes to control the flow of material, such as urine or food, through it.

Spinal cord A column of nerve cells (neurons) that runs down your backbone and connects your brain to the rest of your body.

Spinal nerve One of 31 pairs of nerves that branch out from your spinal cord.

Sweat A watery liquid produced by glands in the skin. Sweat cools down the body as it evaporates.

Synapse The junction where two nerve cells (neurons) meet but do not touch.

System A group of organs that work together. Your mouth, stomach, and intestines make up your digestive system.

Tendon A cord of tough connective tissue that links muscle to bone.

Tissue A group of cells that look and act the same. Muscle is a type of tissue.

Toxin A poisonous substance released into the body by a disease-causing bacterium.

Trachea (Windpipe) The main airway leading from the back of your throat to your lungs.

Ultrasound An imaging technique that uses inaudible, high-frequency sound waves to produce pictures of a developing baby in the womb or of body tissues.

Vein A blood vessel that carries blood toward your heart.

Vellus hair One of the millions of fine, soft hairs that grow all over your body.

Virus A kind of germ that invades cells and multiplies inside them. Diseases caused by viruses include the common cold, measles, and influenza.

Vitamin One of a number of substances needed in small amounts in your diet to keep your body healthy.

Vocal cords The small folds of tissue in your voice box that vibrate to create the sounds of speech.

Voice box (Larynx) A structure at the top of the trachea that generates sound as you speak. The sound is created by folds of tissue that vibrate as you breathe out.

White blood cell Any of the colorless blood cells that play various roles in your immune system.

White matter Brain tissue made up mainly of the axons (long fibers) of nerve cells. The inner part of the brain consists largely of white matter.

X-rays A form of radiation that reveals bones when projected through the body onto photographic film.

